

Shadow Fleet Enforcement Risk

A maritime sanctions-enforcement & cost-transmission briefing on Russia's shadow-fleet oil trade — what is tightening, through which cost channel, and over what horizon.

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1 · Executive Outlook

NERAI's Russia Shadow-Fleet Enforcement Pressure Index reads **35/100 (Low-Moderate)**, with a 13-week forecast of **Stable**. Sanctions enforcement and Russia-West deterioration are real but moderate; the maritime-interdiction signal is **0 in our feed this cycle** (a coverage gap — see below, not confirmed absence). Yet Russian fossil-fuel export revenue is **€726 million/day (+2% m/m)** — global oil prices and volumes, not enforcement, dominate the revenue line.

Bottom line: the enforcement architecture is tightening at the margins, but cost transmission to vessel operators and cargo owners remains weak — low-friction transit persists even as regulatory walls slowly close. The **Black Sea (66/100, Elevated)** is the one corridor already in an **Act-driven** phase; the rest are Threat- or Mixed-phase. Watch the gap between regulatory escalation and physical interdiction.

■ **Coverage note:** NERA's feed did not capture vessel interdictions this cycle, but external reporting indicates at least one material intervention (a France-linked seizure of a Russia-associated tanker near Sicily, ~25 June). Treat the interdiction score as a lower bound, flagged for manual review.

2 · Key Facts

Indicator	Reading	Note
Enforcement Pressure Index	35 / 100 (Low-Moderate)	13-week forecast: Stable
Top corridor	Black Sea — 66/100, Elevated	Only Act-driven corridor this cycle
Russian fossil revenue	€726 mn/day (+2% m/m)	CREA; ≈€21–22 bn/month — no fiscal stress
Urals–Brent discount	-\$12.9 / bbl	Urals \$60.1 vs Brent \$73; wider = more bite
Ruble (USD/RUB)	77.8 (+6.0% / 4wk)	Weaker ruble = macro stress
Maritime interdictions (feed)	0 this cycle*	*coverage gap — verify externally

3 · Cost-Transmission Channels

How enforcement turns into commercial cost — the part that separates this from a geopolitical headline:

Signal	Cost channel	Who is exposed
Sanctions enforcement rising	Compliance, legal review, due diligence	Traders, banks, brokers
Vessel detention / seizure	Delay, demurrage, legal disputes	Owners, charterers, cargo owners
Flag / ownership opacity	Insurance-validity risk, port denial	Underwriters, P&I, ports
Oil-route / chokepoint stress	Longer voyages, bunker cost	Owners, charterers
USD / oil moves	Freight pricing, cargo value, fuel	Owners, charterers, financiers

4 · Corridor Watch

Corridor	Score	Phase
Black Sea	66 (Elevated)	Act-driven
English Channel	59 (Moderate)	Threat-driven
Singapore / Asia-bound	56 (Moderate)	Mixed
Baltic / Danish Straits	54 (Moderate)	Mixed
Mediterranean / Sicily	54 (Moderate)	Threat-driven
Suez Route	50 (Moderate)	Mixed

5 · Watch Indicators

- Confirmed vessel interdiction → immediate risk alert (currently a feed coverage gap — verify externally).
- Composite > 75 for two consecutive weeks → upgrade to Elevated.
- A corridor's Act score exceeding its Threat score → phase shift to Act-driven (Black Sea already there).
- Russia–EU relations +10 w/w → legal-retaliation watch; oil +10% with enforcement active → cargo-value risk upgrade.

6 · Strategic Forecast

NERAI forecasts **enforcement pressure, not freight rates**. The composite is projected **Stable** across horizons (4-week 35, 13-week 35, 26-week 35, 52-week 34), driven by the Russia-West relations component; event-based components (sanctions actions, interdictions) are held at current level. Any freight/premium percentage you may see elsewhere is an indicative analyst scenario, not observed market pricing.

7 · Methodology Note

The NERAI Russia Shadow-Fleet Enforcement Pressure Index (v1) is a 0–100 composite of four real, sourced signals: sanctions enforcement (OFSI/UK + GDELT), Russia-West deterioration (GDELT), maritime interdiction (trade-press events) and oil-route stress (IMF PortWatch chokepoints + Brent). Vessel-level flag/registry and insurance/P&I; components are excluded (not proxied), pending data. Revenue is CREA's published estimate; ruble/Brent/Urals are market data. This is a descriptive enforcement-pressure index for horizon scanning — not a freight-rate forecast and not a substitute for transaction-level vessel screening or legal advice.